

Constraints

- Restricting the possible actions that can be performed
- Helps prevent user from selecting incorrect options
- Physical objects can be designed to constrain things
 - e.g. only one way you can insert a key into a lock
 - External slots in a computer have been designed to only allow a cable or card to be inserted in a certain way.

Logical or ambiguous design?



Image Source: www.baddesigns.com

- Where do you plug the mouse?
- Where do you plug the keyboard?
- top or bottom connector?
- Do the color-coded icons help?

How to design them more logically



Image Source:
www.baddesigns.com

(i) A provides direct adjacent mapping between icon and connector

(ii) B provides color-coding to associate the connectors with the labels



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